# How to Compete

# How to compete

## 1. Meet your teammates.

Meet your teammates, assigned based on experience and skillset. You have until 11:00 a.m. to make any changes to your team. Any team changes must be agreed upon by all impacted teams.

## 2. Choose a frame.

**Education: The "Agency" Guardrail**

- **The Problem/solution:** your team IDs
- **The Constraint:** Your app must solve a problem where the AI is the *scaffolding*, not the *solution*. It must empower a learner to do something they couldn't do before, without doing it *for* them.

**Economics: The "Transparency" Guardrail**

- **The Problem/solution:** your team IDs
- **The Constraint:** Your app must expose a 'hidden' economic factor. Whether it's taxes, environmental debt, or social capital, the spec must focus on turning invisible data into actionable financial insight.

**Environment: The "Accountability" Guardrail**

- **The Constraint:** Your app must bridge the gap between a macro-problem (climate change) and a micro-action (buying a coffee). The spec must rely on verifiable data points, not just 'vibes.'

**Ethics: The "Inclusion" Guardrail**

- **The Constraint:** Your app must actively mitigate a specific human bias or privacy risk. Your Kiro spec must include an 'Ethics Logic Gate'—a piece of code that stops the process if a privacy rule is violated.

## 3. Choose your signal(s) -- how you'll be evaluated.

⚙️ **BUILD SIGNAL:** How well did you leverage AI to build? We want to see technical ambition and powerful implementation across different Kiro features and capabilities.

Building something functional is the minimum; blow us away with your architecture, workflows, and manifestation of the end product.

🤝**COLLABORATION SIGNAL:** How did your team innovate through diverse areas of expertise? Break down how you each used Kiro in your workflows. Judges need to understand how each role on your team impacted your ideation and design processes, development experience, and end product.

🌍 **IMPACT SIGNAL:** Does this matter in the real world? Judges will be looking for meaningful solutions that make sense for tangible problems. We need to understand the problem being addressed, ethics involved and responsible design choices, and customer journey where a real person would use your app.

📣 **STORY SIGNAL:** Are you leading others with transparent workflows that scale? Judges want to see a polished presentation, clear documentation, and active posting within the community. Tell us about how and where you have talked about your project publicly, next steps you are planning, and why you think your build is scalable and extendible for others' learning.

# 4. Build with Kiro!

a. Use Kiro's spec-driven development to create your solution in less than 24 hours.

   i. Create a local project and upload to your team Github account.

b. All teams must pre-record a 2-3 minute pitch explaining their problem, process, solution and signals.

   **i. Must be a Youtube URL (unlisted).** Content over 3 minutes will not be viewed or scored.

c. All teams must submit their **deliverables on Airtable** along with submission details including: signal category and credited team mates.

   i. Free blurb on the submission form about the process of building.
   ii. How was Kiro used in your project? Think about features like vibe coding, SDD…
   iii. How did you use Kiro? Think about your workflow and the features you used, like vibe coding, spec-driven development, agent hooks, steering docs, MCP, or Kiro powers.

d. Need a Kiro refresher? Watch our workshop with Aditya Challa, AWS https://asu.zoom.us/rec/share/APYGtLL6SDSKSjFFnLa8ySOjYMfhtFgJZrl4enLedCAyuMq1U8zWZC0eV3J46iMq.UXoYgIK8N7F2Jpqj

e. Bonus prizes:
   - The team submit their favorite social post on the final form
     - URL to the post

- Team mates social media tags

# 5. Submit by 11:59 p.m. MST on 4/24

1. Include a Project built with Kiro (**Github URL**) and meets our [Project Requirements.](#) Provide a URL to your open source code repository for judging and testing.
2. Include a **text description** that should explain the features and functionality of your Project.
3. Include a **pre-recorded pitch that includes a demonstration video** of your Project. Teams should outline their problem, solution, process and competing signals.
4. Provide a **write up on how Kiro was used**. Judges must understand how effectively you used Kiro to develop your project.

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Example solutions:

| Education frame<br>**Your app must solve a problem where the AI is the scaffolding, not the solution. It must empower a learner to do something they couldn't do before, without doing it for them.** |
|---|
| Example |
| A real-time translation tool for study groups that uses Kiro to spec out a "Context-Aware" dictionary so technical terms don't get lost in translation across 5+ languages. |
| An app where a Designer specs the "Stress Level" UI and the Dev specs the "Assignment Priority" logic, creating a shared dashboard that balances workload for neurodivergent students. |
| A low-bandwidth "Spec-Lite" app that turns heavy video lectures into interactive, text-based summaries for students with limited internet access. |
| A "Skill-Tree" builder where the code's spec is completely transparent, showing the student exactly how their data is being used to verify their mastery of a subject. |

## Economics frame

**Your app must expose a 'hidden' economic factor. Whether it's taxes, environmental debt, or social capital, the spec must focus on turning invisible data into actionable financial insight.**

| Example |
| --- |
| A complex calculator that uses Spec-Driven Development to "Audit" freelance contracts for unfair clauses or hidden fees using natural language processing. |
| A micro-lending platform where the "Strategy" lead defines the risk-assessment spec and the "Dev" implements the automated ledger. |
| An app that scrapes local cost-of-living data to tell a gig worker exactly how many hours they need to work to meet their specific financial "Stability Spec." |
| A visualization tool that tells the "story" of a dollar spent on a local product, tracing how much stays in the community vs. leaving it. |

## Environment frame

**Your app must bridge the gap between a macro-problem (climate change) and a micro-action (buying a coffee). The spec must rely on verifiable data points, not just 'vibes.'**

| Example |
| --- |
| A technical heavy-lifter that integrates multiple environmental APIs to create a "Universal Carbon ID" for common household objects. |
| A tool built *within* the hackathon that specs out how much energy a piece of code takes to run, helping the team optimize their own app's footprint. |
| A tool that takes a photo of a piece of trash and, based on a "Local Municipality Spec," tells the user exactly which bin it goes in to avoid recycling contamination. |
| An app focused on narrative; it generates a "Biography" for a t-shirt, using data-driven specs to explain the environmental journey from cotton field to closet. |

## Ethics prompt:

**Your app must actively mitigate a specific human bias or privacy risk. Your Kiro spec must include an 'Ethics Logic Gate'—a piece of code that stops the process if a privacy rule is violated.**

| Example |
| --- |

| Ethics prompt:<br>**Your app must actively mitigate a specific human bias or privacy risk. Your Kiro spec must include an 'Ethics Logic Gate'—a piece of code that stops the process if a privacy rule is violated.** |
| --- |
| An application that uses a "Zero-Knowledge Spec" to allow users to verify their identity (e.g., student status) without ever revealing their name or address to the host. |
| A team-built tool where the "Design" lead defines what "Neutral UI" looks like and the "Dev" specs out the filters that remove gendered language from job descriptions. |
| A tool that scans other websites and uses a "Universal Design Spec" to highlight exactly where they are failing users with visual or auditory impairments. |
| A social feed where the user can "see" the spec. It provides a toggle for the user to change the algorithm's rules themselves, putting the power back in the human's hands. |

# Challenge Rules

# Project Requirements

**What to Create:** Entrants must build a working software application addressing a challenge in Education, Environment, Ethics, or the Economy, all in 24 hours using Kiro Agentic AI (any combination of features like specs, vibe coding, agent hooks, steering docs, MCP, powers) and submit it into one of the following categories (each a "Project").

## Categories:

⚙️ **BUILD SIGNAL:** How well did you leverage AI to build? We want to see technical ambition and powerful implementation across different Kiro features and capabilities. Building something functional is the minimum; blow us away with your architecture, workflows, and manifestation of the end product.

Emphasis is on:

- Potential Value (1x)
- Implementation (1.5x)
- Quality and Design (1x)

🤝 **COLLABORATION SIGNAL:** How did your team innovate through diverse areas of expertise? Break down how you each used Kiro in your workflows. Judges need to understand how each role on your team impacted your ideation and design processes, development experience, and end product.

- Potential Value (1x)
- Implementation (1x)
- Quality and Design (1.5x)

🌍 **IMPACT SIGNAL:** Does this matter in the real world? Judges will be looking for meaningful solutions that make sense for tangible problems. We need to understand the problem being addressed, ethics involved and responsible design choices, and customer journey where a real person would use your app.

- Potential Value (1.5x)
- Implementation (1x)
- Quality and Design (1x)

📣 **STORY SIGNAL:** Are you leading others with transparent workflows that scale? Judges want to see a polished presentation, clear documentation, and active posting within the community. Tell us about how and where you have talked about your project publicly, next steps you are planning, and why you think your build is scalable and extendible for others' learning.

- Potential Value (1.25x)

- Implementation (1x)
- Quality and Design (1.25x)

### Functionality:

The Project must be capable of being successfully installed and running consistently on the platform for which it is intended and must function as depicted in the video and/or expressed in the text description.

### New & Existing:

Projects must be newly created by the Entrant.

### Third Party Integrations:

If a Project integrates any third-party SDK, APIs and/or data, Entrant must be authorized to use them in accordance with any terms and conditions or licensing requirements of the tool.

## Submission Requirements

Submissions to the Hackathon must meet the following requirements:

- Include a Project built with Kiro and meets the above Project Requirements.
- Include a text description that should explain the features and functionality of your Project.
- Include a demonstration video of your Project. The video portion of the Submission:
    - should be less than three (3) minutes. Judges are not required to watch beyond three minutes
    - should include footage that shows the Project functioning on the device for which it was built
    - must be uploaded to and made publicly visible on YouTube, Vimeo, Facebook Video, or Youku, and a link to the video must be provided on the submission form on the Hackathon Website; and
    - must not include third party trademarks, or copyrighted music or other material unless the Entrant has permission to use such material.
- Provide a URL to your open source code repository for judging and testing.
    - The repository must contain all necessary source code, assets, and instructions required for the project to be functional. The repository must be public and open source by including an open source license file. This license should be detectable and visible at the top of the repository page (in the About section).
    - The code repository must be public with an approved OSI Open Source License (instructions here on how to add it)
    - Your repo must contain the /.kiro directory at the root of the project to show usage of specs, hooks, steering, etc. Do NOT add the /.kiro directory or sub-folders to your .gitignore, as this could disqualify your submission.

- Provide a write up on how Kiro was used. Judges must understand how effectively you used Kiro to develop your project. Show us your next-level understanding of Kiro features, e.g.:
    - Vibe coding: How did you structure your conversations with Kiro to build your project? What was the most impressive code generation Kiro helped you with?
    - Agent hooks: What specific workflows did you automate with Kiro hooks? How did these hooks improve your development process?
    - Spec-driven development: How did you structure your spec for Kiro to implement? How did the spec-driven approach improve your development process? How did this compare to vibe coding?
    - Steering docs: How did you leverage steering to improve Kiro's responses? Was there a particular strategy that made the biggest difference?
    - MCP: How did extending Kiro's capabilities help you build your project? What sort of features or workflow improvements did MCP enable that otherwise would have been difficult or impossible?

**All submissions will be evaluated for the overall prize and each category prize. Entrants do not need to indicate which categories specifically they want to submit to.**

**Submissions MUST indicate any bonus prize (Fan Favorite or Social Blitz) they would like to submit to and include the required submission materials specific to those bonus prizes.**

- **How to submit to Fan Favorite:** Enter by sharing your demo to [ASU channel for participants] with a brief writeup on your project.
    - In your hackathon submission form, you must provide a link to your project in [ASU channel].
    - To be considered, you must post during the hackathon submission period. The community will vote on their favorite projects during the judging period. You may not vote for your own project. Community members are permitted 3 votes total. The top voted project is the winner.
- **How to submit to Social Blitz:** Enter by posting on social (X, LI, IG, or BlueSky) your favorite thing about Kiro with a description of how it changed the way you approached development or enabled you/your team to build something meaningful.
    - In your hackathon submission form, you must provide a link to the social post you want evaluated for the bonus prize. Only one link may be included per submission.
    - To be considered, you must post during the hackathon submission period, tag @kirodotdev in your post, and use the hashtag #kirospark. Kiro team will review submissions and select a favorite. Kiro team reserves the right to choose the favorite post as the winner.

Submissions must be the original work of the Entrant, be solely owned by the Entrant, and not violate the IP rights of any other person or entity.

All Submission materials must be in English or, if not in English, the Entrant must provide an English translation of the demonstration video, text description, and testing instructions as well as all other materials submitted.

## Modifying a project after the submission period

Once the Submission Period has ended, you may not make any changes or alterations to your Submission. The Sponsor and Administrator may permit you to modify part of your Submission after the Submission Period for the purpose of adding, removing or replacing material that potentially infringes a third party mark or right, discloses personally identifiable information, or is otherwise inappropriate. The modified Submission must remain substantively the same as the original Submission with the only modification being what the Sponsor and Administrator permit.

## Testing

Access must be provided to an Entrant's working Project for judging and testing by providing a link to a website, functioning demo, or a test build. If Entrant's website is private, Entrant must include login credentials in its testing instructions. The Entrant must make the Project available free of charge and without any restriction, for testing, evaluation and use by the Sponsor, Administrator and Judges until the Judging Period ends. Judges are not required to test the Project and may choose to judge based solely on the text description, images, and video provided in the Submission.

If the Project includes software that runs on proprietary or third party hardware that is not widely available to the public, including software running on devices or wearable technology other than smartphones, tablets, or desktop computers, the Sponsor and/or Administrator reserve the right, at their sole discretion, to require the Entrant to provide physical access to the Project hardware upon request.

## Intellectual Property

Your Submission must: (a) be your (or your Team, or Organization's) original work product; (b) be solely owned by you, your Team, your Organization with no other person or entity having any right or interest in it; and (c) not violate the intellectual property rights or other rights including but not limited to copyright, trademark, patent, contract, and/or privacy rights, of any other person or entity. An Entrant may contract with a third party for technical assistance to create the Submission provided the Submission components are solely the Entrant's work product and the result of the Entrant's ideas and creativity, and the Entrant owns all rights to them. An Entrant may submit a Submission that includes the use of open source software or hardware, provided the Entrant complies with applicable open source licenses and, as part of the Submission, creates software that enhances and builds upon the features and functionality included in the underlying open source product. By entering the Hackathon, you represent, warrant, and agree that your Submission meets these requirements.

### Financial or Preferential Support

A Project must not have been developed, or derived from a Project developed, with financial or preferential support from the Sponsor or Administrator. Such Projects include, but are not limited to, those that received funding or investment for their development, were developed under contract, or received a commercial license, from the Sponsor or Administrator any time prior to the end of Hackathon Submission Period. The Sponsor, at their sole discretion, may disqualify a Project, if awarding a prize to the Project would create a real or apparent conflict of interest.

## Judges and Criteria

Eligible submissions will be evaluated by a panel of judges selected by the Administrator. Judges may be employees of the sponsor or third parties, may or may not be individually listed on the hackathon website, and may change before or during the Judging Period. Judging may take place in one or more rounds with one or more panels of Judges, at the discretion of the Administrator and Sponsor.

Stage 1. The first stage will determine via pass/fail whether the ideas meet a baseline level of viability, in that the Project reasonably fits the theme and reasonably applies the required APIs/SDKs featured in the hackathon.

Stage 2. All submissions that pass Stage 1 will be evaluated in Stage 2 based on the following equally weighted criteria (the “Judging Criteria”) according to the sole and absolute discretion of the judges:

For overall prizes, all projects will be evaluated by the following criteria equally (1x). For best-in-signal category prizes, judges will look closer at specific criteria most relevant to those signals (also detailed in each category above):

- For the Build Signal category, the Implementation criteria will be weighted 1.5x
- For the Collaboration Signal category, the Quality and Design criteria will be weighted 1.5x
- For the Impact Signal category, the Potential Value criteria will be weighted 1.5x
- For the Story Signal category, the Potential Value criteria and Quality and Design criteria will each be weighted 1.25x

### Potential Value

Includes the extent to which the solution can be widely useful, easy to use, accessible, etc. Examples of considerations could include:

- How unique or saturated the market is with these kinds of applications/solutions
- Whether the UI is intuitive and brings the app functionality to the next level
- If there is a clear need, extensibility, or other type of scalability of the project

### Implementation

Includes how well the idea is leveraging Kiro. Judges must understand how effectively Kiro was used to develop the project. Examples of effective usage include but are not limited to:

- The variety of Kiro features/capabilities impactful in project development
- The depth of understanding or benefit gained from a given Kiro feature/capability
- The amount of experimentation and strategic decisions made in how Kiro features/capabilities are brought into the individual's development workflow.

### Quality and Design

Includes creativity, originality, responsible design, and polished design of the project, such as:

- Finding and using unique public resources like datasets
- Solving a challenge in a unique way
- Building in delightful UI experiences or other thoughtful choices

The scores from the Judges will determine the potential winners of the applicable prizes. The Entrant(s) that are eligible for a Prize, and whose Submissions earn the highest overall scores based on the applicable Judging Criteria, will become potential winners of that Prize.

## Intellectual Property Rights

All Submissions remain the intellectual property of the individuals or organizations that developed them. By submitting an entry, entrants agree that the Sponsor will have a fully paid, non-exclusive license to use such entry for judging the entry. Entrants agree that the sponsor and Administrator shall have the right to promote the Submission and use the name, likeness, voice and image of all individuals contributing to a Submission, in any materials promoting or publicizing the Hackathon and its results, during the Hackathon Period and for three years thereafter. Some Submission components may be displayed to the public. Other Submission materials may be viewed by the sponsor, Administrator, and judges for screening and evaluation. By submitting an entry or accepting any prize, entrants represent and warrant that (a) submitted content is not copyrighted, protected by trade secret or otherwise subject to third party intellectual property rights or other proprietary rights, including privacy and publicity rights, unless entrant is the owner of such rights or has permission from their rightful owner to post the content; and (b) the content submitted does not contain any viruses, Trojan horses, worms, spyware or other disabling devices or harmful or malicious code.